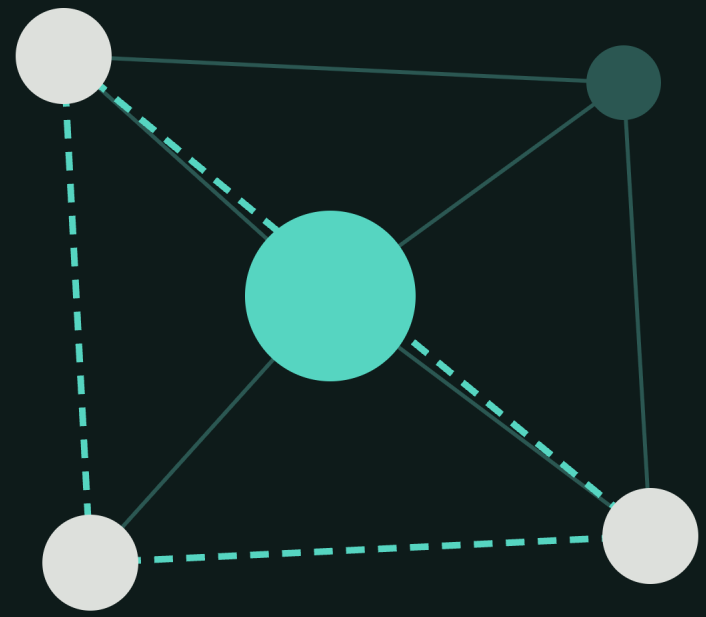
SOCIAL HACK 2026 · CONNECT & INTERSECT

Nodal

Find the people your project is missing, and the trades where helping each other costs nothing.

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THE PROBLEM

Starting a project, two things go wrong

01

You can’t find the people

The skills your project is missing belong to someone you’ve never met.

02

You don’t know if it’s worth it

Is anyone else building this? Does anyone want it? Research takes days.

THE PROMPT: CONNECT & INTERSECT

People, ideas and tools, and what happens where they meet



People

Matched to projects both ways: who fits my need, and whose need do I fit.



Ideas

Projects from software, hardware and creative work that share a topic, surfaced side by side.



Tools

A research agent checks each idea against the web, with sources.

Where they intersect: trades. A swap or a ring, where helping each other replaces hiring.

WHAT'S NEW: THE INTERSECTION

Nobody has to hire anyone

Swap



You need sound design. Rin needs your hardware skills. You fill each other's gaps.

Ring



Three people, each helps the next. Dev helps you back, so the loop closes.

When work needs a reward: bounties in **Tolken**, our in-app currency. No real money.

HOW IT WORKS

A graph that scores closeness

People and projects are nodes. An edge means “this person can fill this need.” Each edge starts at 50:

Signal	Points
Skill level	+15 per level
Category fit	+20
Shared tags (up to 3)	+5 each
Two-way match	+25

Then find the loops

Swaps are 2-person cycles. **Rings** are 3-person cycles.

Ranked by score, shown on the project graph and under “Trades for you.”

Explainable by design: every match shows the reasons behind its score · Tolken ledger can’t go negative · FastAPI + Supabase, Next.js + React

HOW IT WORKS

A research agent that cites its sources



Market check

Competitors, demand, market size, risks. Every claim links to the page it came from.

Cool factor

Novelty, demo appeal, and how fun it is to build with others. Ignores money.

HOW IT'S BUILT

Tech stack and APIs

Frontend

Next.js 15 (App Router) · React 19 · Tailwind CSS 4 · Base UI · Lucide · Sonner

Backend

Python · FastAPI · Pydantic v2 · Uvicorn · SlowAPI rate limits · in-memory graph cache

Data

Supabase: Postgres with row-level security, Auth, Storage for images and source zips

External APIs

TinyFish web search and page fetch · **OpenRouter** → Gemini 2.5 Flash for the research agent

LIVE DEMO

Watch it work, in three beats

1

Intersect

Projects from different worlds that care about the same thing. Post an idea; the research agent checks it.

2

Connect

The graph finds Rin, a swap. The invite is a DM; she accepts from her side.

3

Collaborate

Fund a ◈ 50 bounty, Rin submits, Maya confirms. It lands on Rin’s profile.

Nodal finds the people your project is missing.

And the trades where helping each other costs nothing.

WHERE IT GOES NEXT

- Campus first: clubs, hackathons and research labs
- Cross-discipline teams: engineering, design and science
- Longer loops: rings beyond three people

Thank you · Questions?